

Another one for the Eee PC

Eee PC the ultra-light, ultra-portable and ultra-cheap Netbook from Asus just bagged itself another award. It's now crowned Forbes Asia's Product of the Year for 2008. The product was chosen for its Innovation and Market Disruption.

**Search may become passé**

Contextual browsing may become the new avatar of search. With browsers and web sites becoming increasingly aware of what you are looking at, all your web content needs will be custom delivered to you in the future.



Enter



Eugene V. Kaspersky
CEO, Head of Antivirus Research,
Kaspersky Lab

One of the world's leading
experts in antivirus protection

What were you thinking of doing after your degree, how did you think your career would go, had you thought of going into this kind of work or were you planning on doing something else?

I have done my degree in Cryptology. I think I was planning on doing something else, I didn't enjoy myself, it was just antivirus systems, it was just my hobby. I got into it by accident. My computer was infected back in 1989 with a cascade virus, back when there was such a virus. That's why I'm here.

How do you tackle human gullibility, which is one of the greatest vulnerabilities out there when it comes to internet security?

There are three things you could do against cyber terrorism, cyber criminals and against all threats — education, law enforcement and protection. We have a special education system for kids and students about this. We do it and we do it for free, because we take it as part of our mission to spread the news. We have presentations given by about 80 experts and this method works.

Isn't it difficult to make people sit up and listen and take notice for such a thing to work?

The problem is that they don't pay enough attention in social networks. They think they trust everyone in a community, and give out data, some personal information, which is enough for to see some serious repercussions. It is one of the greatest threats, probably one of the most serious because there are millions of people who are in this network.

WHY IS ANDROID?**Who is Google?**

No there's no grammatical error there. Well, although there is, it's intentional.

Think about it. Since the time Google announced its open source android operating system for mobiles, people have wondered — why is Google launching a product that has no apparent revenue model? The question has come to the forefront once again with the launch of T mobile's HTC G1. The phone is pretty nifty and we especially like the flip-slider opening keyboard. Android works fairly smooth too. But coming back to what Google is upto — perhaps its recent announcement that the iPhone and T-Mobile G1 can now show Google search ads sheds a little light on the question. Is Google then going the Microsoft way? Monopoly being the name of the game. For instance, reports suggest T-Mobile's G1 works fine with many online services, but it works especially well with Google's. It delivers a lot of the basic core functions and of course, tight integration with Google's products, including Gmail, Google Maps, and Google Calendar.

Having said that, there is also a lack of basic features like video recording. Is it a miss out, or more like an opportunity for independent app developers? Google has



come up with a mobile application store of its own, called Android Market ala iPhone. Besides, some of Google's latest antics include asking broadband carriers to create a special fastlane exclusively for its content. This would be done by placing Google servers in the ISP's technical facilities. Another somewhat alarming warning sign is the removal of Firefox as the default browser in the

Google code pack. In a recent US survey of the top 20 most trusted companies, Google has fallen off the list entirely from its spot at 10 on last year's list. Google's fall is probably due to the

big company syndrome, where people just start trusting big companies less. Perhaps Google should treat these signs as early warnings. Besides this, there is a lot of fuss being kicked up about Google Maps post the Mumbai terror attacks. An Indian lawyer filed a petition in the Mumbai High Court, arguing that Google Earth and similar services "aid terrorists in plotting attacks". The petition is demanding a removal of Google

Earth satellite images of India, or at the very least, blur images of sensitive places in the country, such as Indian nuclear plants and defence establishments. And it's not just Indians. A group of Japanese lawyers and professors have also asked Google to stop providing detailed street-level images of Japanese cities. Google provides this through its Street View service, which offers

Security Watch**Critical security flaw in IE (again)****The problem**

Microsoft recently issued a critical security warning regarding a malicious code that is making the rounds and attacking vulnerabilities in Internet Explorer 7. The infection had the potential for wide-spread damage since IE 7 is the latest non-beta version of Microsoft's browser and is bundled with XP service pack 3 and also Vista. The code, infects a users' system with a Trojan horse. It may even start downloading other malicious elements into the users system. Microsoft says that the code can creep in even through legitimate websites in which the script has been inserted to run in the background. Earlier versions of IE are also vulnerable. It is being said that Microsoft Corp.'s developers missed the bug because they didn't have the right testing tools. Microsoft's testing tools — including "fuzzers," which are automated tools that drop data into applications, file formats or operating system components to see if and where they fail — also missed the bug.

The solution

Microsoft has released an emergency update patch MS08-078 which addresses the vulnerability. The patch fixes a flaw in the data-binding function of all available versions of the popular browser. Users who have automatic updates turned on will receive the patch automatically while others can access it via a download from Microsoft's web site.

ground-level, 360-degree views of streets in 12 Japanese cities and is also offered for some 50 cities in the United States and certain areas in Europe.

As for the Android, we'll wait and watch. At the time of going to print, Kogan Agora Pro, the second Android phone was launched in Australia for \$399 AU (Rs. 13,000). Unlike T-Mobile's G1, this phone comes unlocked for use on any carrier.

WHAT WILL APPLE DO?**No more Jobs**

Mid December news wires are abuzz with the hullabaloo of Steve Jobs quitting Macworld and Apple opting out of the event altogether, after the January installment. Mac fanboys cried themselves to sleep speculating whether Job's health is behind the move, but the more plausible reason is that, like many companies, Apple is getting tired of trade shows. For many companies, the expense and complexity of exhibiting at huge shows,

then having to compete with hundreds or thousands of other companies for press and industry attention, are making the shows less and less compelling. Goes to show that the trade show biz isn't exactly a growth industry these days and, with tough economic times ahead, luxuries like your precious keynote are the first to go. Apple now probably plans to go in for its own exclusive product launches. Although Mac and Apple are synonymous, it is worth mentioning here that the Macworld Expo is run by IDG World Expo.

Knowing Apple's penchant for control, chances are that Macworld Expo didn't offer Apple enough control.

Also interesting is what these expos do to the share price of Apple Inc. A prelude to all of Apple's media events is crazy rumor mongering and speculation. The result is that almost every Apple extravaganza since Macworld 2007, no matter what news comes out of it, has triggered a massive sell-off of Apple stock. Initial reports suggest that Apple stock may have dropped nearly 7 per cent on the news that Steve Jobs

HOT**BBC allows YouTube to carry content**

Small sections of programs and promotional segments of BBC videos have been allowed to stay on YouTube in exchange for a share of the advertising revenues of the video sharing web site.

Viacom removes content from YouTube

Viacom and subsidiaries MTV, Nickelodeon and Comedy Central have pulled more than 100,000 clips from YouTube. The lawyers are unsure of the website is actually giving a boost to the content owned by Viacom or dealing it a blow.

is quitting Macworld.

For Mac enthusiasts what Steve Jobs' departure means is that there will be no more jazzy stunts in the Keynote, which Jobs was famous for. During the launch of the iPhone he pulled out the phone from his jeans pocket and called the local Starbucks Café for 4000 Lattes to go. But realistically speaking, Mac-lovers can probably rest assured Apple's not going to come apart cheap the minute Jobs leaves.

NO MORE RECORDS**Data Retention**

Post 26/11, security measures and privacy issues are much talked about. So the news that search companies are cutting down on search-data retention time, is of much relevance.

Search companies keep the IP addresses of their users for a period before making them anonymous. Until they anonymise the

